

Resonac Holdings (4004.T): Announces additional investment in HD media for AI data centers, unusual price hike agreement

Resonac announced additional investments in increasing HD media capacity on July 28. The company plans to invest c.¥15 bn at its Singapore site to increase HD media capacity for AI data center nearline applications by c.20 mn units/year, utilizing some idle equipment to raise investment efficiencies (production lines will be brought online in phases from 2029 onward, depending on market trends and demand). Moreover, in a move that is highly unusual for a Japanese materials company, the company said it had agreed to price revisions with its HDD manufacturer customers that are equivalent to the planned investment. Management aims to simultaneously expand supply capacity and enhance profitability. Resonac only recently announced a 50 mn unit/year capacity increase on May 11, 2026 (slated to commence operations in phases in 2027), and including both announcements, its HD media production capacity is set to increase by c.44% from c.160 mn units at present to c.230 mn units. The company's HD media generates the second-largest portion of sales in its semiconductor and electronic materials business after copper-clad laminates/prepregs (based on our FY12/26 estimates). With the positive impact of price hikes likely, in addition to medium- to long-term volume growth, our impression of the news is positive. We reiterate our Buy rating.

Citing data from an external research firm, the company expects strong demand growth, with a +23% CAGR in nearline HDD shipment capacity from 2025 to 2030. Against this backdrop, the latest release reflects management's intent to solidify a stable supply framework through timely and flexible investments as the world's only merchant HD media supplier. While a 50-mn-unit/year capacity increase is already under way at the Singapore site, with operations set to come online sequentially from 2027, this new investment plan will add a further 20-mn-unit/year capacity increase on top.

Furthermore, the explicit mention that the company has secured agreements from its HDD manufacturer customers for price hikes equivalent to the investment amount on this project (although the magnitude and timing of the price hikes have not yet been disclosed) leaves a favorable impression, as it formally validates the company's efforts to raise prices. Disclosures that go so far as to explicitly state price revision agreements within a capacity expansion announcement are rare in the Japanese materials sector. As such, we believe this will be seen positively as a signal of Resonac's strong industry positioning as the only merchant manufacturer, its high technological prowess, and its disciplined approach to investment.

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Price Target Risks and Methodology - Resonac

We are Buy rated on Resonac with a 12-month target price of ¥23,920. Our target price is based on the correlation between the materials sector's EV/GCI and the FY12/27E CROCI/WACC (cash-return multiple of 0.7X plus a 30% premium to the sector average). Key risks include a slowdown in semiconductor demand, yen appreciation, and decline in graphite electrode earnings.

4004.T	12m Price Target: ¥23,920	Price: ¥12,305	Upside: 94.4%
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Buy		GS Forecast				
Market cap: ¥2.2tr / \$13.6bn		Revenue (¥ bn)	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Enterprise value: ¥2.9tr / \$18.0bn		Op. profit (¥ bn)	1,347.1	1,443.6	1,582.8	1,716.1
3m ADTV: ¥56.1bn / \$350.2mn		Op. profit CoE (¥ bn)	46.7	149.9	259.1	317.7
Japan		EPS (¥)	—	105.0	—	—
Japan Chemicals & Advanced		P/E (X)	160.5	545.4	954.2	1,185.2
Materials		P/B (X)	25.7	22.6	12.9	10.4
M&A Rank: 3		Dividend yield (%)	1.0	2.6	2.1	1.7
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?:		N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	1.6	0.5	0.5	0.5
Yes		CROCI (%)	5.0	2.8	1.6	1.0
			5.7	8.0	10.0	11.2
			3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E
		EPS (¥)	84.4	—	—	—

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 28 Jul 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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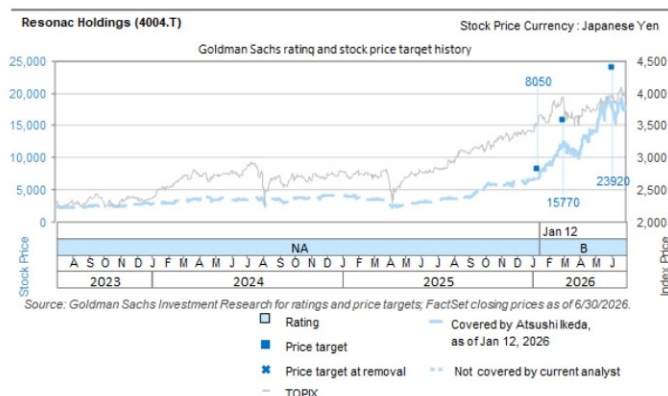
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Resonac Holdings (4004.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
05-Jun-26	23,920	17,315
01-Mar-26	15,770	11,930
12-Jan-26	8,050	6,810

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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